

SECTION 7

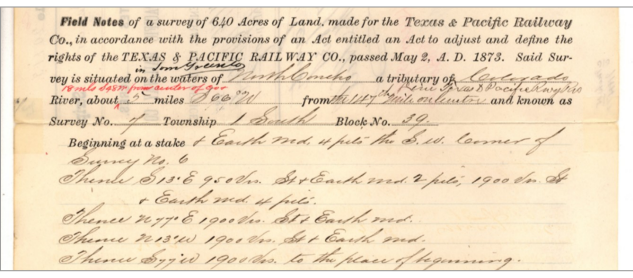
Block 39, Township 1 South, Texas & Pacific Railway Company Survey · Abstract 34 · Midland County, Texas

ONE SQUARE MILE *Desk Edition. Compiled from records, not walked.*

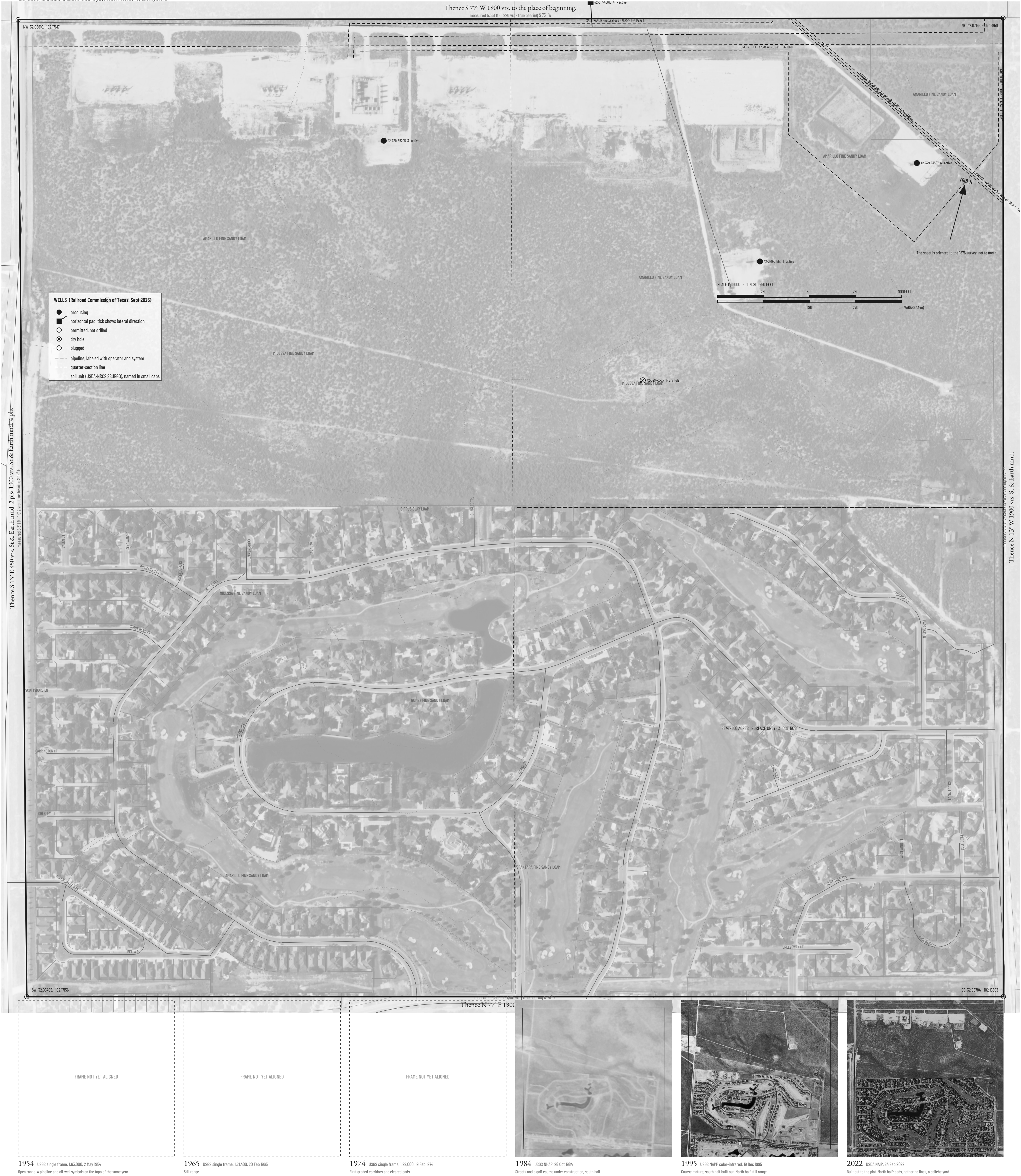
First edition, October 2026. One copy. Corrections invited; anyone who corrects it gets the second edition free.

Beginning at a stake & Earth mound, 4 pls, the S.W. corner of Survey No. 6

Surveyed 1 February 1876 and docketed under Martin County. Corrected to Midland County in red ink, 1887, two years after Midland County was organized. The county this ground sits in was itself a correction. On this sheet, red means the record disagreed with itself, or ran out.



Powell's field notes, 1 Feb 1876, as filed. "Martin," struck. GLO Bear Scrip File 020113.



CHAIN OF TITLE, 1876-1982 · complete, no gaps

1876. Surveyed 1 Feb by deputy surveyor W.C. Powell, chain carriers L.E. Wright and E.C. Bennett, "on the waters of North Concho." Bearings in varas. Filed at the General Land Office 27 Dec.
1876. Land Scrip No. 3123, 25 May: the Texas & Pacific has built 203 miles, 4,624 feet of railroad. This section is part of what that construction earned. Odd-numbered — railroad land, not school land.
1883. Patented 15 Dec to Texas and Pacific Railway Co. Patent 540, Vol. 68, p. 503, 640 acres.
1906. Charles J. Canda, trustee of the Texas Pacific Land Trust → Mrs. Mary T. Edwards, 640 acres. Recorded 6 Jan 1906, Deed Records 12/54. Three notes of \$795.
1911. Mary T. Edwards and heirs → S.H. Holloway, with Sections 6, 8, 17, 18; buyer assumes the 1906 notes. Four months later Holloway → S.W. Estes. The Estes years begin.
1921. S.W. and Armintha Estes → Thelma Estes, about 160 acres.
1926. Ethel Aldredge Estes → Aldredge Estes Jr.
1978. The Estes family → Midland West Corp., 31 Oct. Surface and surface rights only, SE/4, 160 acres. Minerals stay with the family. Consideration: ten dollars and the note.
1981-82. Midland West → Haico Inc. (plat-joinder parcel). BSD Inc. → Midland West, agreement.
1982. Green Tree North plat recorded 1 Dec. Cabinet C, p. 134. Developer: Midland West Corporation.
The chain stops here. Sixty-seven years of one family; ninety-nine years of ranch. Everything since is somebody's home and is not this map's business.

THE GROUND

Water. Ogallala aquifer 100–180 ft below the section. One City of Midland well inside the line, 147 ft, unused. About ten domestic and irrigation wells drilled 2002–2021, 135–180 ft. Golf course well, 175 ft, 2021. Midland Draw crosses the north half and has carried its name on every USGS sheet from 1954 to 2019 — it never disappeared; the ranch did. Powell's 1876 notes call this "waters of North Concho." Modern mapping drains it east to the Colorado by Midland Draw and Beals Creek; the North Concho is not on the path.
Soil. About 60% Amarillo and Midessa fine sandy loam — well drained, "farmland of statewide importance." Bippus clay loam in the draws, subject to occasional flooding. No hydric soils. Water table below 80 in. A "sandy old farm with one sickly tree," as the man who sold it put it in 1977.
Oil. Inside the line: three producing wells, one permitted location, one dry hole. On the north line, three horizontal pads whose laterals run south under the streets. Two crude gathering lines (Oryx "Green Tree" system, 6.63 in) and one 16-in gas transmission line (ONEOK WesTex) cross the north half. Operators of record as of September 2026; dates and depths could not be pulled.
Before the streets. Open rangeland on every USGS edition 1954–1985; oil wells, drill holes, a gravel pit, a pipeline. Streets first appear 1991. Built out by 2010.
The course. Summer 1977: two men buy 320 acres from the Estes family, one of them the head pro at Ranchland Hills. First National Bank finances it — \$8.9 million, later litigated. Dirt-trail access until 1980. Course opens 1980–81; nine more holes 1985; rebuilt 2018.
The measure. Powell called 1,900 varas on every side. The county's polygon measures 1,910 to 1,926. The section holds about 650 acres against 640 patented — ten acres of survey excess that nobody has had to account for in 150 years.

COULD NOT BE CONFIRMED

Compiled from records, not walked. The following were looked for and not found, or found and not trusted:
· Identity of the pipeline drawn on the 1954 and 1966 USGS sheets.
· Whether the 1978 gathering line is the T-4 Permit 10611 "Green Tree" system. Likely: not shown by any single record.
· Completion dates and depths of the wells (RRC identify service unavailable at compilation).
· Which quarter Thelma Estes received in 1921.
· Whether Thelma Estes and Ethel Aldredge Estes are the same person. No instrument says so.
· Haico Inc.: who they were. The nature of the 1982 BSD Inc. agreement.
· First lot sold, first house built, first price paid.
· Any 1930s–40s aerial. A 1944 Air Force frame exists at TxGIO and was not ordered.
· Powell records a magnetic variation of 12° 9½' E; applied conventionally his lines would run near-cardinal. The ground runs 14° off. Which convention he used is not known.
· Anything the Reporter-Telegram printed about this ground; the archive is paywalled.
If you know any of these, write. Second edition is free to anyone who corrects the first.

Sources. Texas General Land Office (patent, field notes, scrip); Midland County Clerk (deed records as cited); Midland Central Appraisal District (abstracts, parcels); USGS topoView and EarthExplorer (topographic sheets 1954–2019; aerials 1954, 1965, 1974, 1984, 1995); USDA NAIP 2022; Railroad Commission of Texas GIS; Texas Water Development Board; USDA-NRCS Web Soil Survey; EPA WATERS / NHDPlus federal court records as cited. Full source log, thirty-eight rows, at github.com/acw1888/One-square-mile.
Gathered by Skippy (Meta Muse). Designed by Claude (Anthropic). Approved and paid for by a resident of the section, who is not named on it. No phone calls were made. Sheet oriented to the 1876 survey; true north 15° right of page-up. Scale 1:5,000. Aerial strip frames aligned to ±150 ft.